

Commemorating

10th

Anniversary of the Formation of BSG Statistics Department

'Cherishing each life'

Towards achieving 1 million members by
2030

HAPPINESS COUNTER



Youth Division

1 4 1 7 6 3



All India

2 8 5 1 7 5

A GOLDEN DECADE OF DEDICATION: ADVANCING WITH THE SPIRIT TO CHERISH EACH LIFE



Dearest fellow comrades of BSG Statistics Department,

Many-many congratulations on the 10th anniversary of the formation of BSG Statistics Department this month. My sincere thanks and deepest gratitude to each one of you for your tireless efforts towards member care. As I write, I am joined by the entire editorial team of ABACUS who have connected with you from time to time, to extend our heartfelt gratitude and share our joy on this special occasion. My heart is filled with happiness and deep appreciation to be a part of BSG Statistics Department and to stand alongside each of you as we strive together and report victory to Ikeda Sensei.

April 27th, 2015 - the day the BSG Statistics

Department was inaugurated – what a day! A gathering of “mathematicians of happiness,” – brimming with determination, conviction, joy, hope and courage. That day marked a fresh start for the statistics incharges as we set out towards our then goal of achieving BSG membership of 100,000. We were truly on the cusp of making history, which came to fruition on 1st August 2015 when we proudly achieved the 100,000-member milestone.

On the day of the inauguration, we received two messages from Ikeda Sensei. In the second he said, **“The Statistics Department is praiseworthy because they are going to take care of newly joined members.”** Since that day, we, the statistics incharges took full responsibility of taking care of all members including the new friends with the spirit of cherishing each life.

Once again, the time has come to renew our vow. With the **New Friends Gatherings held across 35 cities in India**, we have welcomed **1946 new friends** to the realm of Soka. As statistics incharges, let us earnestly pray and take decisive action to connect these precious lives to their districts, support leaders and members in encouraging these new friends and teach them Gongyo & Daimoku, ensure that their details are accurately captured in BDS and help them attend regular meetings to fully savor the joy of faith and practice.



Formation of BSG Statistics Department, New Delhi, 27th April 2015

Ikeda Sensei writes, **“Teaching the immense mercy of Nichiren Daishonin and the profundity of Buddhist teachings is a most difficult task. But to do so is our noble mission. Our every effort is vital to protect and support those people to whom we have introduced to the Mystic Law so that they can attain Buddhahood and enjoy supreme happiness in this life. We do so for the benefit of those people, for the cause of the Law, and for the benefit of society”** (BSG Statistics Department Handbook, p. 28). Now as we advance towards our goal of

350,000 membership this year and one million by 2030 in BSG, it will be all of us together who will be creating another golden chapter in the history of kosen-rufu worldwide.

With our growing victories in managing BDS, marking regular attendance and promptly responding to transfers and introductions, let's create a new record of victories for all times to come!

Let's win for Sensei! Let's win for our comrades!

With warmest regards
Dinesh Bhatnagar ●●●

ETERNAL GUIDELINE FOR THE STATISTICS DEPARTMENT

“A membership card is not a piece of paper; it is the life of one person. In it, the life pulsates, the personality is contained, and the drama of awakening in faith and rebirth is played out. There exist the human-to-human bonds of warm trust. Because we have been cherishing each person to the utmost, we see the magnificent development of the Soka Gakkai today.”

- Daisaku Ikeda (December 15, 2002)

BSG STATISTICS DEPARTMENT MOTTO

“With the heart of oneness of mentor and disciple, we cherish each life as Bodhisattva of the Earth and strive diligently towards the dynamic and eternal advancement of Kosen-rufu.”

Excerpts from the collection of Ikeda Sensei's guidance to Statistics Incharges

Ikeda Sensei has encouraged statistics incharges for their valuable contribution to advancing kosen-rufu, taking up the most challenging and unnoticed behind the scenes work always opening a new path. As we commemorate the 10th anniversary of the formation of BSG Statistics Department this month, ABACUS Editorial team presents a collection of Ikeda Sensei's guidance for statistics incharges.

EACH STATISTICS RECORD IS A PRECIOUS LIFE

Numbers are not mere numbers. Each number represents the irreplaceable life of one person. It encapsulates the happiness of a person's life. This is why we uphold the goal to thoroughly cherish each person, and enable that person to form a connection with Buddhism, and continue to do so one person at a time. From that one person, we expand the great solidarity of peace and happiness.¹

Everything begins from one person. Maintaining statistics for kosen-rufu is none other than the action of a Buddha who spreads the Mystic Law and guides each person to absolute happiness.

As long as we continue to cherish and encourage one person, the Soka Gakkai will continue to develop even further. The magnificent drama of worldwide kosen-rufu is just beginning.²

CHERISHING ONE SINGLE INDIVIDUAL IS OUR PRIME POINT

Second Soka Gakkai president Josei Toda, who was a genius at mathematics, often used to say, "In any field of endeavour, numbers must be calculated. We of the Soka Gakkai make calculations to keep track of how many infinitely precious lives are being protected, how many people have embraced the Mystic Law, and how many people we have enabled to realise genuine happiness."³

One human being is infinitely worthy of respect. The noble Buddha nature exists in every person wherever that person may be throughout the world. This is the Buddhist perspective.

Let's once again confirm the prime point of cherishing each person.

¹ BSG Statistics Department Handbook, p. 49

² BSG Statistics Department Handbook, p. xi-xiii

³ BSG Statistics Department Handbook, p. 28

While nurturing each and every person and using our voices to encourage each person, let us foster capable individuals, who are treasures of the Soka Gakkai so that each and every one of them becomes strong and wise. It is then that we can manifest twice, three times, even ten times more strength.⁴

This spirit of the Statistics Department not to allow even one person become unhappy and to enable everyone to become victors of happiness is truly the sun that revives people's hearts.⁵

EACH INDIVIDUAL IS PRECIOUS

"Though the 4,994,828 men and women in Japan have each a mother and father, when we examine the matter, we find that they are in fact the children of Shakyamuni Buddha, the lord of teachings."

('The Two Meanings Implied in the Nembutsu Leading to the Hell of Incessant Suffering', WND-2, 302)

Nichiren Daishonin had a clear grasp of the size of the entire population, as well as the number of districts and villages in Japan. There is a life and story behind every single number. The Daishonin's concern with these detailed numbers is a manifestation of his earnest wish to lead all people without exception to happiness.

The Statistics Department is responsible for the noble task of keeping up-to-date records of our members, an endeavor that embodies the Daishonin's spirit. Each membership card represents the life of one individual.

I am absolutely certain that the unseen virtue accumulated through the steadfast and arduous efforts of our Statistics Department members is certain to bring triumphant visible reward.⁶

EACH INDIVIDUAL HAS A MISSION AS BODHISATTVA OF THE EARTH

We are all Bodhisattvas of the Earth who have been born together at this time to sow the seeds of the Mystic Law in the heart of one person after another and realize happiness for ourselves and others. As the proud protagonists of kosen-rufu in the Latter Day of the Law, let us boldly and confidently fulfil our mission as Bodhisattvas of the Earth.⁷

⁴BSG Statistics Department Handbook, p. 50

⁵BSG Statistics Department Handbook, p. xii-xiii

⁶VC, Feb 2019, p. 32

⁷VC, May 2016, p. 55

I hope you will make an effort to personally visit and encourage each member, showing your genuine, heartfelt care.

Meeting people forges personal ties. Sincere words impart courage to others, which in turn expands our network of hope.

Even though your efforts to share Buddhism may be rebuffed, your sincere intent is sure to leave its mark. It can change even opponents into allies.⁸

There may be some members who are not able to attend as many meetings as they would like right now. There may be others who have distanced themselves from the organization for a long. But they are all Bodhisattvas of the Earth who have embraced the Mystic Law, being blessed with “great good fortune from past existences.” (LSOC27, 356) The seeds of Buddhahood sown in the fields of their hearts cannot fail to sprout, grow and flower. That is why we must chant Nam-myoho-rence-kyo with strong faith and send waves of “the greatest of all joys” (OTT, 212) into the hearts of our fellow members, why we must persevere in our sincere efforts to visit and encourage them.

Soka experts in the art of encouragement don the “robe of gentleness and patience” (cf. LSOC 10, 207) and display the compassionate spirit of warmly embracing and accepting everyone.

Even if someone doesn’t immediately make a fresh determination to stand up in faith and participate in SGI activities, there’s no need to be impatient. Based on the principle of “three thousand realms in a single moment of life,” your every prayer and action, and the message you impart, will function to produce future changes.⁹

And the day will come when those you have reached out to will show their appreciation. Some day they will happily tell others that you helped them stand up in faith or became the people they are today.

Your aim is to play that role in the lives of as many people as you can. There is no greater treasure in life than this.¹⁰

⁸ VC, Apr 2016, p. 44

⁹ VC, May 2016, p. 4

¹⁰ VC, Jan 2015, p. 106 ●●●



MY JOURNEY OF SHAKUBUKU: TRANSFORMING CHALLENGES INTO TRIUMPH

V. Preeti

**Chapter Statistics Incharge,
North India Area**



Scan to listen to
the experience

I joined this life transforming philosophy in March 2013 amidst severe challenges—collapse of our family business, repeated job losses and health setbacks. After 5 years of diligent practice and arduous struggle, I finally got stable work as a Digital Marketing Trainer in 2018.

I got appointed as a district statistics incharge in 2019 followed by a chapter statistics incharge in 2020. I immediately created an excel sheet to track and organize data, helping leaders in identifying and reconnecting with inactive members. I personally made 300 phone calls to inactive members and conducted 100 home visits to rekindle their faith and practice. Based on heartfelt dialogues, I could shakubuku 25 lives to this practice. Additionally, I facilitated 70 transfers ensuring members remained connected to the practice regardless of their location.

During 2021-22 I introduced 25 more guests to this practice. Around this, I was also planning to launch my business with the support of an investor who later backed out. Ikeda Sensei says, **“Prayer in Nichiren Buddhism means making a vow to win without fail”** (VC, Jan 2022, p. 15). Without giving up, I strengthened my vow and chanted earnest daimoku to transform my karma. I experienced numerous personal victories during my journey. In April 2023, I started my own business—a coaching academy and advertising agency—using my savings.

I overcame a severe health challenge in July 2023 and fully recovered. My family’s victories included buying a car, investing in a house, and my younger brother securing a stable job in Pune.

From Jan to Mar 2025, the district where I am attached has chanted 975 hours of daimoku. We welcomed 9 new guests and 11 inactive members—including 1 YWD, 1 MD, and 9 WDs. Towards the March 16th gathering, I could do 118 calls, 30 home visits and 23 dialogues. 18 youth attended the meeting from our region. Determined that no one is left behind, I meticulously updated BDS records, helped statistics incharges in using BDS, ensured all pending leadership appointments were marked in BDS, and supported members in subscribing and renewing value creation.

By being a statistics incharge, I understood the true spirit of Shakubuku—reaching out to people and helping them transform their lives. To date, I have introduced 60 lives to this practice, with 52 actively practising today. I consistently chanted for their happiness and victories; while also ensuring they are connected to their respective districts and became actively engaged in Gakkai activities.

Today, I vow to introduce 40 new lives to Daishonin’s Buddhism in 2025 and contribute fully toward our goal of 1 million by 2030. ●●●

Mathematicians of the Month

Timely attendance marking is an expression of reporting victory to Ikeda Sensei by statistics incharges!

Introducing the zones where all the districts marked the 'Discussion Meeting' attendance in the month of March 2025.

We accord these zones as 'MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH' for March 2025.

MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH

Delhi - East

Ananda - Lotus
Expressway - Jaypee
Ghaziabad
Greater Noida
Greno West
Indraprastha
Noida
Noida - Vasundhara
Noida City Centre
Noida West
Sahibabad - Meerut
Surya Nagar
Uttarakhand
Vaishali

Delhi - North

Central Pitampura
Delhi University
Mansarovar - Naraina
Model Town - Chatrasal
Paschim Vihar - Punjabi Bagh
Pusa
Rajouri
Rohini

East India

Central Kolkata
Dumdum
Odisha North 1
Salt Lake - Himalayan
South Central
Tolly Jadavpur - Bihar
Upper Assam

Delhi - West

Aravali
DLF 1 & 3
DLF 2 & 4
Dwarka - Palam
Dwarka - Uttam Nagar
Epicentre
Golf Course
Janak Puri
Nirvana
Palam Vihar
SBTG
Shanti Path
Sohna
Vasant Kunj East
Vasant Kunj West
Vikaspuri

Delhi - South

Alaknanda - GK 2
Badkal - Faridabad
CR Park - Kalkaji
Charmwood
East of Kailash
Faridabad
Green Park
Hauz Khas
Lajpat Nagar
New Friends Colony
Sainik Farm
Saket

South India

AP - Telangana (East)
AP - Telangana (North)
AP - Telangana (South)
Bangalore East
Bangalore South
Bangalore South Central
Bangalore South East
Bangalore South West
Chennai Central
Chennai East
HAL - Hennur

North India	West India - 1	West India - 2
Amritsar	Andheri - Surat	Bandra
Chandigarh	Baner - Central	Chembur - Ghatkopar
Jaipur Midtown	Goregaon Malad West	Gateway
Jammu	Goregaon - Baroda	Goa
Kanpur	Kandivali Dahisar West	Juhu Link - Yari Road
Lucknow	Koregaon - Airport	Juhu Vile Parle
Lucknow - Gorakhpur	Magarpatta - Kharadi	Khar Santacruz BKC
Mansarovar	Mira Virar	New Mhada Amboli
Mohali	Nasik - Aurangabad	Sion Parel
Panchkula East	PCMC - Aundh	Tardeo Malabar
Panchkula West	Powai Mulund	Worli Prabhadevi
Rajasthan East	Pune South	
Vaishali	Thane - Kalyan	

MEETINGS IN APRIL 2025

Date	Meeting Type	Responsibility to mark attendance
6 th April 2025	Young Phoenix Meeting	Region Statistics Incharge
13 th April 2025	Gosho Study Meeting	District Statistics Incharge
27 th April 2025	Discussion Meeting	District Statistics Incharge

Let's promptly mark the attendance of the above meetings and report victory as statistics incharges!

Do You Know?

- 1) When a leader is transferred, all existing appointments will be automatically removed from the BDS. The receiving unit must re-mark the appointments.
- 2) A member is considered an overseas comrade once they relocate and are deactivated in the BDS. As a result, they will no longer have access to the BSG Trailblazer portal.
- 3) Division Graduation (e.g., YWD to WD, YMD to MD, Cubs to YP, YP to YL, YL to SD/YMD/YWD) is done from Region Statistics Login.
- 4) A member's personal details can be updated from the District Statistics Login.

ATTENDANCE MARKING THROUGH BSG CONNECT PLUS MOBILE APP

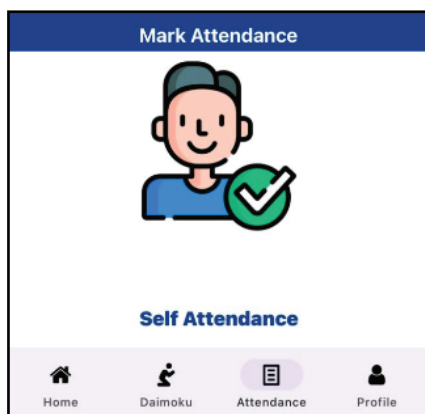
BSG Connect Plus is a mobile app for all BSG members and leaders which can be majorly used to record daimoku and mark attendance.

Let's learn about attendance marking through the app.

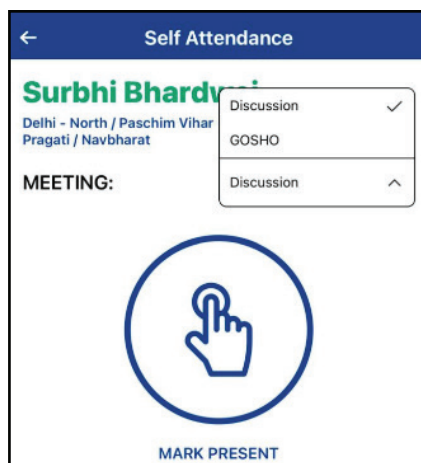
The app can be used by all members and leaders to mark their own attendance, and by the district statistics incharge (DSI) to record the attendance for the entire district.

Q. How to mark self-attendance?

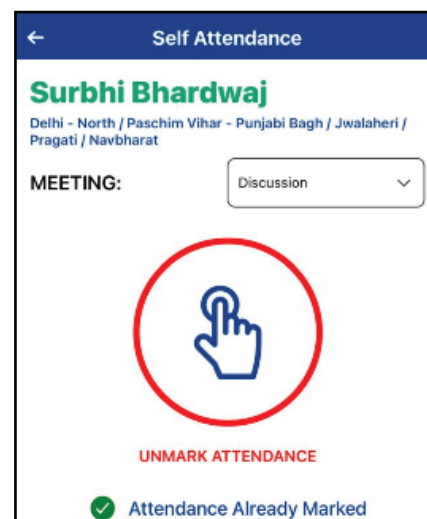
Login to BSG Connect Plus Mobile app, click on attendance and then on Self Attendance



Select the meeting type – Discussion or Gosho and then click on 'Mark Present'



The next screen will show that attendance has been marked

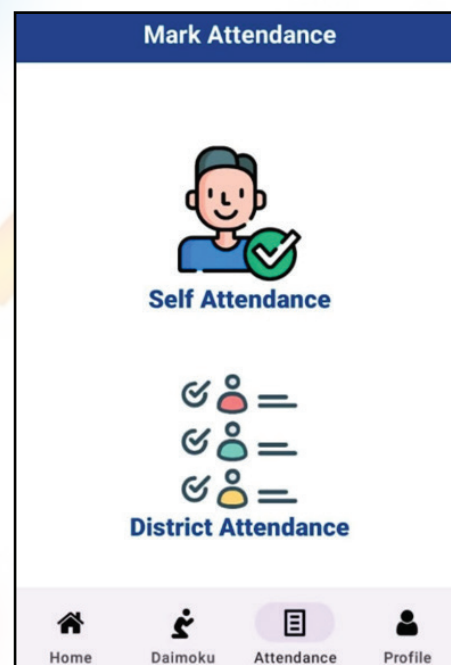


Q. How can a DSI mark the district's attendance?

A DSI can also mark the attendance of the district from the app (This feature is only available to those who are marked as DSI in BDS).

To mark,

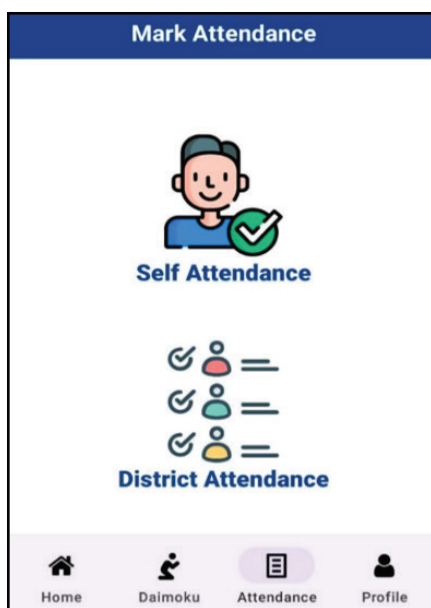
- Click on attendance
- Click on district attendance
- Mark the attendance and submit



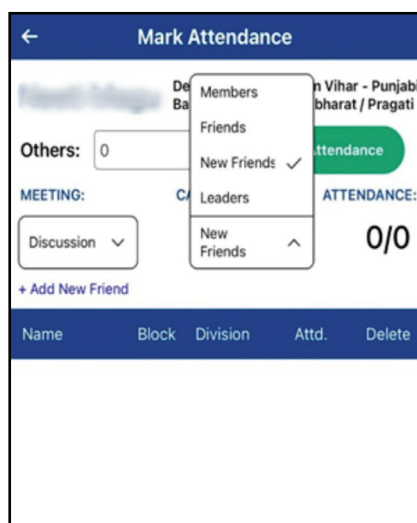
New Feature for District Statistics Incharges (DSI)

There is a new feature being added to the **BSG Connect Plus** mobile app of all appointed DSIs. They can now add 'New Friends' while marking the attendance through the app.

Click on attendance and then on District Attendance



Select the meeting type as Discussion and select category. To add 'New Friend', select New Friends and then click on 'Add New Friend'



Fill in all the details and press 'Submit'. The New Friend is now added.



This feature can be used on the **latest version** of the **BSG Connect Plus** Mobile app which can be downloaded/ updated from  for all android users and from

 for iOS users.

BSG Statistics Department General Meeting

Commemorating the **10th** anniversary of formation of
BSG Statistics Department

Will be held on Friday, 18th April 2025 at area / city level

Let us reach out to our statistics incharges and together renew our vow to continue to advance kosen-rufu as a mathematician of happiness



ABACUS Editorial Team, in conversation with

Rahul Khanna

Region Statistics Incharge, West India-2 Area



Please share your journey of being a statistics incharge?

Also, if you would like to share any success story?

I started my journey as a YMD in 2011 and was later given the responsibility of district and statistics.

I recall an incident when, in a hurry to add a new guest to the MDS, I misspelled their name. I was then guided that these were not just names – they were disciples of Ikeda Sensei, entrusted to us. Hence, we must care for each life with utmost respect and dignity. *It was then I understood how important the role of a statistics incharge is for the advancement of kosen-rufu and that marking attendance is an expression of reporting victory to Sensei. But why do it immediately? It is because responding with speed is the hallmark of Bodhisattvas of the Earth. Ikeda Sensei always responded to Toda Sensei with speed, and from being district to region statistics incharge, I have striven to do the same.*



How has being a statistics incharge helped you personally?

I have been in the field of finance for 15 years – same as the years of my practice. My training as a statistics incharge has instilled in me a deep commitment to accuracy, the discipline of updating information, being consistent, and a keen attention to detail.

Additionally, planning and mindfulness have become integral aspects of my daily life, shaping the way I approach everything around me.



Please share your experience of working on BDS?

For me MDS to BDS is like going from Analogue world to Digital world.

BDS is much faster, easier and instinctive. The only suggestion is if we could have *flexibility* in customising our downloadable reports.



Do you read ABACUS regularly? What is the importance of ABACUS for you?

I read ABACUS regularly and I look forward to read the experiences and Sensei's guidance which are specific to the statistics incharges.

ABACUS is brief and a ready reference for me.



What is your determination as statistics incharge?

My foremost determination is to correct the data in my region BDS for each member, map the family tree and keep BDS updated.

Secondly, I want to train and empower all my statistics incharges to proactively manage statistics. Me and my zone statistics incharge are determined to strengthen Malabar Hills region statistics. ●●●

Puzzle for Mathematicians of Happiness



Think you've mastered the ins and outs of BDS appointment processes? Put your knowledge to the test with this fun and engaging matching puzzle! Match each question in **Column A** with the correct answer in **Column B**. Challenge yourself and see if you can get them all right!  

COLUMN A	COLUMN B
1) "We need to appoint a Block Chief. Who will initiate the appointment process in BDS?"	Region Statistics Incharge
2) "Who will be responsible for marking the interaction for the Zone Chief appointment?"	BDS Helpdesk
3) For Region Chief appointment, force push can be used when these leaders have given approval from AAC1?	Area Statistics Incharge
4) Who is responsible for marking the appointment of the Zone Statistics Incharge in BDS?	Area Leaders - all 4 divisions
5) For Region Chief(s) appointment, who is the Appointment Approving Committee 1?	Any 4 National Leaders - different divisions
6) "Who is responsible for marking the appointment of the District Chief in BDS?"	Any 4 Area Chiefs - different divisions
7) For Zone Chief appointment, force push can be used when these leaders have given approval from AAC1?	Districts Statistics Incharge

We are looking forward to your answers by
30th April 2025

Please send your answers at
statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org

ANSWERS OF LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE

- 1) heartfelt, trust
- 2) swore, dynamically
- 3) refused, genuine

- 4) treasure, growth
- 5) swore, pledge

LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE WINNERS



North India

Akansha Malgani
Anushka Harwani
Juhi Agrawal
Kalpana Kunwar
Shivang Mittal
Shubham Patel

Delhi South

Indrani Ghosh
Shweta Ghosh
Varsha Agarwal

Delhi North

Shobha Dube

Delhi West

Leena Mehta



South India

Kiran Ramchandani
Sudha Agrawal

West India 1

Aruna Patra
Rina Iyer
Sonia Jhingon

Delhi East

Priyanka Dwivedi

West India 2

Jigna Kotecha
Rajani Bahadure

East India

Bharati Dash
Jaya Chatterjee
Tapati Mukherjee

BDS HELPDESK



In case of any query or assistance on BDS, please write to: helpdesk@bharatsokagakkai.org or create a ticket on BDS under 'Ticket System'.

FEEDBACK

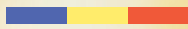


We look forward to hearing from you!

Please write to us if you have any feedback on the newsletter or if you wish to share your experience as statistics incharge; please mail us at : statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org



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the 10th anniversary
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encourage one person, the Soka Gakkai
will continue to develop even further.
The magnificent drama of worldwide
kosen-rufu is just beginning.”*

- Daisaku Ikeda

Towards BSG of 1 million members by 2030, I am determined to



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